HKU BUSINESS SCHOOL

Master of Business Administration (International)

IMBA6116 Manage Black Swan

A. GENERAL INFORMATION

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B. COURSE DESCRIPTION

Our world is being shaped by a large number of unprecedented events, including the rapid spread of covid-19 and the deterioration of the relationship between China and America. They have wreaked havoc on individuals, businesses, and societies, all across the world. Within a very short period of time, business have been made or destroyed, and fortunes have been won or lost. Business leaders and policy makers all have to make decisions under such extreme degree of uncertainty.

This course aims to help business leaders and policy makers to improve their decision making under extreme uncertainty. It synthesizes the recent research on Black Swan events and develops ideas and tools for managing them. It will deal with the following questions. What are Black Swan events? How do they affect investment, business and society? What can we do to make better decisions in the world full of Black Swan events?

C. COURSE OBJECTIVES

1. To introduce basic concepts, tools and theories to handle Black Swan events.
2. To train decision-making abilities under extreme uncertainties.
3. To prepare students for challenges in the complicated business worlds.

D. PROGRAMME LEARNING OUTCOMES

PLO 1.	Acquisition of knowledge and understanding of various business concepts and skills
PLO 2.	Application of business knowledge to analyze and solve real business situations
PLO 3.	Inculcating professional ethics and competency in business
PLO 4.	Developing global outlook
PLO 5.	Mastering communications and interpersonal skills in business settings
PLO 6.	Developing managerial leadership

E. COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

(amend the highlighted content as appropriate)

Course Learning Outcomes		**Aligned Programme Learning Outcomes (PLOs)**
CLO1	Understand the fundamental decision making concepts and process.	1, 2,4
CLO2	Apply the Black Swan randomness concept to establish an anti-fragile system in organizations	1,2, 4,5
CLO3	Evaluate the different nature of risk and uncertainty in the real world.	1,2,3,4
CLO4	Develop leadership and team work skills in making decision under extreme uncertainty	2,3,4,5,6

F. COURSE TEACHING AND LEARNING ACTIVITIES

(amend the highlighted content as appropriate)

Course Teaching and Learning Activities		**Aligned Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs)**
T&L1.	*Lecture with interactive discussion*	CLO 1, 2, 3,4
T&L2.	*After-class review and discussion*	CLO 1, 3
T&L3.	*Case-based study and analysis*	CLO 1, 2, 3,4
T&L4.	*Self-study*	CLO 1, 2

Assessment Methods		Brief Description	Weight	Aligned Course Learning Outcomes
A1.	Lecture attendance and Class Participation		20%	CLO 1, 2, 3
A2.	Course Essay		50%	CLO 1, 2, 3,4
A3.	Group case discussion		30%	CLO 1, 2, 3,4
		Total	100%	

G. STANDARDS FOR ASSESSMENT

(amend as appropriate)

COURSE GRADE DESCRIPTORS	
A+, A, A-	Overall, a very impressive and excellent piece of work, equivalent to a distinction. Includes the majority of the following features: - Demonstrates an understanding of the task which may be beyond what is expected, but which is always relevant. - Original perspective on the problems in question. Contextualization of sources and viewpoints and comprehensive evaluation of contributions. Application of relevant theories in answering the question. - Use of a wide range of relevant sources, well understood and critically evaluated. - Well-structured and organized with a clear line of reasoning. Appropriate length. - Clear, articulate style with accurate spelling, word choice and grammar. Referencing follows consistent academic conventions with all references fully and accurately cited.
B+, B, B-	Overall, a good and commendable piece of work. Includes the majority of the following features: - Demonstrates sound understanding of the task. Presentation of points and arguments generally relevant to the question. - Sustained commentary on evidence and materials used. Inclusion of appropriate critical perspective. Use of theoretical models in a relevant way to answer the question. - Sound understanding of main sources of literature, well summarized and used in a critical and relevant way. - Clear structure and presentation. Control of length - Generally accurate spelling, word choice and grammar. Generally consistent and accurate referencing.
C+, C, C-	Overall, a satisfactory piece of work. Includes the majority of the following features: - Understands main point of the task. Most points and arguments presented are relevant to the question. - Adequate commentary on evidence and materials used. Some evidence of critical awareness. Use and understanding of theoretical models, but in a fairly pedestrian way.

COURSE GRADE DESCRIPTORS	
	- Adequate range of source material consulted. Clear understanding of the literature used. - Good structure and presentation, minor problems in organization do not impede communication. Control of length. - Comprehensible spelling, word choice and grammar, inaccuracies do not impede meaning. Generally consistent referencing.
D+, D	Overall, a bare pass. Includes the majority of the following features: - Understanding of basic concepts and effort made to relate them to the question. - Argument mainly descriptive points and/or points which require greater substantiation. More development of ideas needed to sustain an argument. Identification of main issues, but little critical awareness. - Some evidence of reading and understanding of the literature, but range and /or relevance very limited. - Attempt made at coherent presentation, but ideas not well integrated. - Comprehensible spelling, word choice and grammar, although inaccuracies may sometimes impede meaning. Some attempt at consistent referencing and control of length
F	Overall, a very poor piece of work. Includes the majority of the following features: - Inadequate understanding or misunderstanding of task. Purely descriptive account with little or no analysis. - Irrelevant comments and/or assertions which are not supported by meaningful evidence. Little evidence of integration of various sources to sustain an argument. Lack of any critical or appreciative framework. - Few relevant sources used and/or little use of literature. - Unstructured presentation and/or lack of coherence which impedes understanding. - Little or no attempt at consistent referencing. Major inaccuracies in grammar, word choice and spelling. Length problematic.

H. ASSESSMENT RUBRICS FOR EACH ASSESSMENT

Grade	Course Grade Descriptor
	Group project presentation *(amend as appropriate)*
A+, A, A-	- Identifies and addresses the main themes and issues clearly. - Demonstrates a comprehensive command of existing arguments relevant to the topic. - The arguments fit together logically and build a compelling case. - The presentation has a succinct outline, structure and conclusion, with clear transition between different parts (by different presenters). - Presenters show full command and understanding of the presented contents (e.g. powerpoint files) which are predominantly their own writing. - Presenters engage the audience at all times through good communication skills (e.g. eye contact, gestures and variation in tone) and adhere strictly to the set time limits.

Grade	Course Grade Descriptor
B+, B, B-	- Identifies and addresses the main themes and issues. - Demonstrates a good command of existing arguments relevant to the topic. - The arguments fit to form a clear position, but some arguments are underdeveloped and some considerations overlooked. - The presentation has an outline, structure and conclusion, with clear transition between different parts. - Presenters show good command and understanding of the presented contents (e.g. powerpoint files) which are mostly their own writing. - Presenters engage the audience through good communication skills (e.g. eye contact, gestures and variation in tone) most of the time and adhere to the set time limits.
C+, C, C-	- The main themes and issues are unclear. - Demonstrates insufficient command of existing arguments relevant to the topic. - Offers own position but the reasoning is impaired by weak arguments. - The presentation has an outline, structure and conclusion, but the transition between different parts is not clear. - Presenters show insufficient command and understanding of the presented contents (e.g. powerpoint files) which are mostly not their own writing. - Some presenters engage the audience relatively ineffectively and some are slightly off the set time limits.
D+, D	- Identifies and addresses the main themes and issues only partially. - Demonstrates a lack of understanding of existing arguments relevant to the topic. - Offers own position but the arguments are poorly made and not well supported. - The presentation is not well structured, and the transition between different parts is not clear. - Presenters show little understanding of the presented contents (e.g. powerpoint files) which are mostly not their own writing. - Some presenters fail to engage the audience and some are off the set time limits.
F	- Failure to identify and address any main theme and issue. - Demonstrates a lack of understanding of existing arguments relevant to the topic. - No coherent own position and the arguments are confused and flawed. - The presentation is not structured, and the transition between different parts is illogical. - Presenters show little understanding of the presented contents (e.g. powerpoint files) which are not their own writing. - The presenters fail to engage the audience and some are off the set time limits.

Grade	Course Grade Descriptor
	Group Project *(amend as appropriate)*
A+, A, A-	- Identifies the topic learned in the field trip clearly and shows good understanding of this topic. - Demonstrates a comprehensive command of existing arguments relevant to the topic. - Shows good application of the topic learned in the field trip. - The report has a clear structure and organization. - The report has very few, if any, errors in grammar and vocabulary.

Grade	Course Grade Descriptor
	- Quoted materials from other sources (with proper citation) are used only to support and strengthen arguments instead of replacing the student's own writing.
B+, B, B-	- Identifies the topic learned in the field trip and shows some understanding of this topic. - Demonstrates a good command of existing arguments relevant to the topic. - Shows some application of the topic learned in the field trip. - The report has some structure and organization. - The report has some errors in grammar and vocabulary. - Quoted materials from other sources (with proper citation) are used to support and strengthen arguments, but sometimes also used to replace the student's own writing.
C+, C, C-	- Identifies the topic learned in the field trip and shows little understanding of this topic. - Demonstrates insufficient command of existing arguments relevant to the topic. - Shows little application of the topic learned in the field trip. - The report is poorly organized. - There are distracting language errors though the overall meaning is still intelligible. - Quoted materials from other sources (with proper citation) are used more to replace the student's own writing than to support and strengthen arguments.
D+, D	- Shows no clear identification of the topic learned in the field trip and little or wrong understanding of this topic. - Demonstrates a lack of understanding of existing arguments relevant to the topic. - Shows no application of the topic learned in the field trip. - The report is poorly organized. - Frequent errors in simple grammar and vocabulary, which are distracting and the overall meaning is not easily intelligible. - Quoted materials from other sources (with proper citation) are heavily used to replace the student's own writing.
F	- Shows no clear identification of the topic learned in the field trip and little or wrong understanding of this topic. - Demonstrates a lack of understanding of existing arguments relevant to the topic. - Shows no application of the topic learned in the field trip. - The report is poorly organized. - Language errors are so frequent and distracting that the report is largely incomprehensible. - Quoted materials from other sources are heavily used to replace the student's own writing, sometimes without proper citation.

Grade	Course Grade Descriptor
	Individual Reflection on Learning *(amend as appropriate)*
A+, A, A-	- Identifies the topic learned in the field trip clearly and shows good understanding of this topic. - Describes the student's current job duties that are related to the topic clearly. - Shows good application of the topic learned in the field trip to one or more of the job duties. - The report has a clear structure and organization.

Grade	Course Grade Descriptor
	- The report has very few, if any, errors in grammar and vocabulary. - Quoted materials from other sources (with proper citation) are used only to support and strengthen arguments instead of replacing the student's own writing.
B+, B, B-	- Identifies the topic learned in the field trip and shows some understanding of this topic. - Describes the student's current job duties that are related to the topic. - Shows some application of the topic learned in the field trip to one or more of the job duties. - The report has some structure and organization. - The report has some errors in grammar and vocabulary. - Quoted materials from other sources (with proper citation) are used to support and strengthen arguments, but sometimes also used to replace the student's own writing.
C+, C, C-	- Identifies the topic learned in the field trip and shows little understanding of this topic. - Shows insufficient description the student's current job duties that are related to the topic. - Shows little application of the topic learned in the field trip to the job duties. - The report is poorly organized. - There are distracting language errors though the overall meaning is still intelligible. - Quoted materials from other sources (with proper citation) are used more to replace the student's own writing than to support and strengthen arguments.
D+, D	- Shows no clear identification of the topic learned in the field trip and little or wrong understanding of this topic. - Shows little or no relationshp between the topic and the student's current job duties. - Shows no application of the topic learned in the field trip to the job duties. - The report is poorly organized. - Frequent errors in simple grammar and vocabulary, which are distracting and the overall meaning is not easily intelligible. - Quoted materials from other sources (with proper citation) are heavily used to replace the student's own writing.
F	- Shows no clear identification of the topic learned in the field trip and little or wrong understanding of this topic. - Shows no relationshp between the topic and the student's current job duties. - Shows no application of the topic learned in the field trip to the job duties. - The report is poorly organized. - Language errors are so frequent and distracting that the report is largely incomprehensible. - Quoted materials from other sources are heavily used to replace the student's own writing, sometimes without proper citation.

I. TEACHING SCHEDULE

Class Date	Content
March 6, 2025	Classifications of Black Swan Randomness and Moderate Randomness, the origin of Black Swan Randomness as a result of breakdown of the independence of individual actions,
March 7, 2025	the cognitive and institutional reasons that lead to Black Swan.
March 8, 2025	the problems of predictions; Long-term Capital Management Case, Madoff Case
March 9, 2025	establish an anti-fragile system, identify optionality in the real world, Pershing Square Case

J. REQUIRED/RECOMMENDED READINGS & ONLINE MATERIALS

See the course preparation notes

K. MEANS/PROCESSES FOR STUDENT FEEDBACK ON COURSE

The Student Feedback on Teaching and Learning (SFTL) questionnaire is one of the ways HKU courses and teaching are evaluated. HKU places significant importance on student learning and on the continuous enhancement of teaching and learning outcomes. Students are asked to complete this evaluation of their learning experiences at the conclusion of each course in which they enrol. Questionnaire items relate to the overall evaluation of the course as well as an evaluation of teaching.

L. COURSE POLICY

The University Regulations on academic dishonesty will be strictly enforced. Please check the University Statement on plagiarism on https://tl.hku.hk/plagiarism/ .

Cheating or plagiarism of any kind would result in an automatic F grade for the course plus strict enforcement of all Faculty and/or University regulations regarding such behavior. Incident(s) of academic dishonesty will NOT be tolerated.

Academic dishonesty is a behavior in which a deliberately fraudulent misrepresentation is employed in an attempt to gain undeserved intellectual credit, either for oneself or for another. It includes, but is not necessarily limited to, the following types of cases:

a. Plagiarism - the representation of someone else's ideas as if they are one's own. Where the arguments, data, designs, etc., of someone else are being used in a paper, report, oral presentation, or similar academic project, this fact must be made explicitly clear by citing the appropriate references. The references must fully indicate the extent to which any parts of the project are not one's own work. Paraphrasing of someone else's ideas is still using someone else's ideas, and must be acknowledged.

b. Unauthorized Collaboration on Out-of-Class Projects - the representation of work as solely one's own when in fact it is the result of a joint effort.

c. Cheating on In-Class Exams - the covert gathering of information from other students, the use of unauthorized notes, unauthorized aids, etc.

d. Unauthorized Advance Access to an Exam - the representation of materials prepared at leisure, as a result of unauthorized advance access (however obtained), as if it were prepared under the rigors of the exam setting. This misrepresentation is dishonest in itself even if there are not compounding factors, such as unauthorized uses of books or notes.

All assignments (i.e. individual papers) will be uploaded to Turnitin for originality checking and to identify potential plagiarism, if any.

Where a candidate for a degree or other award uses the work of another person or persons without due acknowledgement:

1. The relevant Board of Examiners may impose a penalty in relation to the seriousness of the offence.

2. The relevant Board of Examiners may report the candidate to the Senate, where there is *prima facie* evidence of an intention to deceive and where sanctions beyond those in (1) might be invoked.